

1 ENGROSSED SENATE AMENDMENT
TO
2 ENGROSSED HOUSE
BILL NO. 4427

By: Hilbert, Pogemiller,
Provenzano, Waldron, and
Ranson of the House

and

Seifried of the Senate

8 An Act relating to adjunct teachers; amending Section
1, Chapter 210, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025,
9 Section 6-122.12), which relates to adjunct teachers;
authorizing public and charter school district to
10 hire adjunct *** teachers from teaching core
curriculum subjects in pre-kindergarten through
11 fourth grade beginning with the 2026-2027 school
year; permitting previously employed adjunct teachers
12 to continue to teach core curriculum subjects in pre-
kindergarten through fourth grade if *** placement
13 teaching certificate; removing adjunct teacher
language; providing an effective date; and declaring
14 an emergency.

15
16 AMENDMENT NO. 1. Page 1, strike the title, enacting clause and
entire bill and insert

18 "An Act relating to teachers; amending Section 1,
Chapter 210, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section
19 6-122.12), which relates to an annual report on
adjunct teachers; allowing public school districts to
20 employ adjunct teachers who meet certain criteria;
directing the State Board of Education to promulgate
21 rules providing certain qualifications for adjunct
teachers; prohibiting adjunct teachers from teaching
22 certain subjects in certain grades beginning in
certain school year; allowing a district to apply to
23 the Board for certain waiver to continue certain
employment; providing eligibility for waiver;
24 prohibiting districts from employing an adjunct

1 teacher for more than certain time period beginning
2 in certain school year; providing for waiver
3 application; allowing the Board to grant a waiver for
4 certain time period; prohibiting certain adjunct
5 teacher from being considered certain teacher;
6 updating statutory reference; updating statutory
7 language; amending 70 O.S. 2021, Section 6-122.3, as
8 last amended by Section 162, Chapter 452, O.S.L. 2024
9 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 6-122.3), which relates
10 to alternative certification; removing language
11 directing the Board to promulgate certain rules;
12 updating statutory language; and providing an
13 effective date.

14 BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

15 SECTION 1. AMENDATORY Section 1, Chapter 210, O.S.L.
16 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 6-122.12), is amended to read as
17 follows:

18 Section 6-122.12. A. Public school districts in this state may
19 employ adjunct teachers who have a minimum of a high school diploma
20 and are persons with distinguished qualifications in their field.
21 The State Board of Education shall promulgate rules providing
22 distinguished qualifications for adjunct teachers.

23 B. 1. Beginning with the 2027-2028 school year, adjunct
24 teachers shall be prohibited from teaching core curriculum subjects
including, but not limited to, mathematics, English language arts,
science, and social studies in pre-kindergarten through fifth grade.

2. If an adjunct teacher was employed by a public school
district to teach a core curriculum subject in pre-kindergarten
through fifth grade prior to the 2027-2028 school year, the public

1 school district may apply to the State Board of Education for a
2 waiver to continue the adjunct teacher's employment. To be eligible
3 for a waiver, the adjunct teacher shall be required to complete or
4 shall have completed professional development training in the
5 science of reading provided by the State Department of Education.

6 If the Board grants the waiver, the public school district may
7 continue to employ the adjunct teacher to teach core curriculum
8 subjects in pre-kindergarten through fifth grade, subject to the
9 limitation provided for in subsection C of this section.

10 C. Beginning with the 2027-2028 school year, public school
11 districts shall be prohibited from employing an adjunct teacher for
12 more than five (5) years unless the employing public school district
13 applies to the State Board of Education for a waiver. The State
14 Department of Education shall develop a waiver application, which
15 shall include a requirement to submit the adjunct teacher's
16 distinguished qualifications. The Board may grant a waiver allowing
17 the adjunct teacher to be employed for an additional five (5) years.

18 D. A person employed as an adjunct teacher pursuant to this
19 section who does not hold a valid certificate to teach shall not be
20 considered a teacher as defined by Section 1-116 of this title.

21 E. The State Department of Education shall publish an annual
22 report on the status of adjunct teachers, authorized by Section 6-
23 122.3 of ~~Title 70 of the Oklahoma Statutes~~ this title, in this
24 state. The report shall include:

1 1. Qualifications adopted by the State Board of Education to
2 determine eligibility of adjunct teacher candidates;

3 2. The subject areas or courses in which adjunct teachers are
4 teaching; and

5 3. The types of distinguished qualifications adjunct teachers
6 have to make them qualified to teach in certain subject areas or
7 courses.

8 ~~B. F.~~ The annual report shall be published on the website of
9 the State Department of Education and copies of the report shall be
10 provided to ~~elected~~ members of the ~~Oklahoma~~ House of Representatives
11 and the ~~Oklahoma State~~ Senate no later than January 15 of each year.

12 SECTION 2. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 6-122.3, as
13 last amended by Section 162, Chapter 452, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp.
14 2025, Section 6-122.3), is amended to read as follows:

15 Section 6-122.3. A. The State Board of Education shall grant
16 an alternative placement teaching certificate to a person who makes
17 application to the Board and meets the following criteria:

18 1. a. holds at least a baccalaureate degree from an
19 institution whose accreditation is recognized by the
20 Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education and has
21 attained a retention grade point average ~~of~~ not less
22 than 2.50 on a 4.0 scale, or

23 b. has successfully completed a terminal degree, such as
24 a doctorate of philosophy, a doctorate in education,

1 professional doctorates, a master of fine arts degree,
2 or a master of library science degree, from an
3 institution accredited by a national or regional
4 accrediting agency which is recognized by the
5 ~~Secretary of the United States Department~~ Secretary of
6 Education. The Oklahoma State Regents for Higher
7 Education shall be consulted to verify other terminal
8 degrees, or

9 c. holds at least a baccalaureate degree from an
10 institution whose accreditation is recognized by the
11 Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education and has
12 qualified work experience in a field that corresponds
13 to an area of certification as determined by the State
14 Board of Education, and

15 d. in addition to the requirements of subparagraphs a, b,
16 ~~and~~ or c of this paragraph, has demonstrated
17 competency or completed a major in a field that
18 corresponds to an area of specialization for an
19 Elementary-Secondary Certificate or a Secondary
20 Certificate as determined by the State Board of
21 Education or a vocational-technical certificate as
22 recommended by the Oklahoma Department of Career and
23 Technology Education;

1 2. Declares the intention to earn standard certification by
2 means of an alternative placement program in not more than three (3)
3 years. The State Board of Education shall determine the subject
4 matter and the number of clock or semester hours required for the
5 professional education component for each person making application
6 for an alternative placement teaching certificate based on the
7 criteria of paragraph 1 of this subsection.

8 The State Board of Education shall establish a core minimum of
9 six (6) semester hours or ninety (90) clock hours and a maximum of
10 eighteen (18) semester hours or two hundred seventy (270) clock
11 hours for the professional education component.

12 The requirements set forth in this subsection shall exclude all
13 student teaching requirements pursuant to the provisions of
14 subsection ~~E~~ F of this section;

15 3. Has passed the subject area portion of the competency
16 examination required in Section 6-187 of this title in the area of
17 specialization for which certification is sought; and

18 4. Either presents a document from an accredited public school
19 district in this state offering employment in the area of
20 specialization for which certification is sought on condition that
21 the person enroll in an alternative placement program approved by
22 the State Board of Education or declares the intention to seek
23 employment as a teacher at an accredited public school district in
24 this state. The certificate granted pursuant to this subsection

1 shall be considered a ~~"valid~~ valid certificate of ~~qualification"~~
2 qualification for the purposes of Sections 6-107 and 6-108 of this
3 title, and the holder of the certificate shall be considered an
4 inductee for the purposes of Section 6-195 of this title.

5 B. An alternative placement teaching certificate shall be
6 renewed for not more than a maximum of three (3) years upon
7 presentation of a document from an accredited public school district
8 in this state offering renewed employment in the same area of
9 specialization and a document from a teacher education institution
10 verifying satisfactory progress in an appropriate alternative
11 placement program.

12 C. Persons enrolled in an alternative placement program shall:

13 1. Have never been denied admittance to a teacher education
14 program approved by the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education,
15 the ~~North Central Association of Colleges and Schools~~ Higher
16 Learning Commission, and by the ~~Oklahoma~~ Commission for ~~Teacher~~
17 ~~Preparation~~ Educational Quality and Accountability to offer teacher
18 education programs, nor have enrolled in and subsequently failed
19 courses necessary to successfully meet the minimum requirements of
20 the program, except those persons who hold a certificate;

21 2. Have on file with the director of teacher education at an
22 ~~Oklahoma~~ institution of higher education in this state a plan for
23 meeting standard certification requirements within three (3) years;
24 and

1 3. Participate in an induction program as required in Section
2 6-195 of this title and have the same duties and responsibilities as
3 other inductees.

4 D. The State Board of Education may grant an exception to the
5 requirements for certification and, upon demonstration by an
6 individual of specific competency in the subject area of
7 specialization, may grant a certificate to the individual. The
8 State Board may establish other requirements necessary to grant
9 exceptions.

10 E. The State Board of Education, in consultation with the
11 Commission for Educational Quality and Accountability, may grant an
12 exception to the requirement to complete a subject area examination
13 for initial certification in a field which does not require an
14 advanced degree pursuant to this section if the candidate has an
15 advanced degree in a subject that is substantially comparable to the
16 content assessed on a subject area examination. The degree shall be
17 from an institution accredited by a national or regional accrediting
18 agency which is recognized by the United States Secretary ~~of the~~
19 ~~U.S. Department~~ of Education. The Commission shall provide the
20 Board with the necessary information to determine comparability.

21 F. Student teaching and a ~~pre-student~~ pre-student teaching field
22 experience shall not be required of alternative placement program
23 participants for standard certification.

1 G. ~~The State Board of Education shall promulgate rules~~
2 ~~authorizing adjunct teachers who shall be persons with distinguished~~
3 ~~qualifications in their field. Adjunct teachers shall not be~~
4 ~~required to meet standard certification. A person employed as an~~
5 ~~adjunct teacher pursuant to this subsection who does not hold a~~
6 ~~valid certificate to teach shall not be considered a teacher as~~
7 ~~defined by Section 1-116 of this title.~~

8 H. Each teacher education institution shall provide the
9 ~~Oklahoma~~ Commission for ~~Teacher Preparation~~ Educational Quality and
10 Accountability an annual report of information as specified by the
11 Commission regarding participation in the alternative placement
12 programs offered by the institution.

13 ~~I. H.~~ H. The ~~Oklahoma~~ Commission for ~~Teacher Preparation~~
14 Educational Quality and Accountability shall not accredit, renew the
15 accreditation of, or otherwise approve any teacher education program
16 of any institution of higher education in this state that has not
17 implemented alternative placement programs in at least four areas of
18 specialization, including mathematics, science, and a foreign
19 language. Each institution shall allow individuals who meet the
20 criteria of subsections A and C of this section to be:

21 1. Admitted to an alternative placement program without further
22 qualification; and

23 2. Offered the opportunity to complete the requirements for
24 standard certification set forth in subsection A of this section

1 during the summer preceding and the summer following the first year
2 of teaching with an alternative placement teaching certificate. Any
3 person seeking standard certification through an alternative
4 placement program shall be permitted to take necessary courses
5 during regular semesters if offered.

6 ~~¶~~ I. The criteria specified in subsection ~~¶~~ H of this section
7 ~~can~~ may be met through a cooperative arrangement entered into by two
8 or more institutions of higher education.

9 SECTION 3. This act shall become effective November 1, 2026."
10 Passed the Senate the 29th day of April, 2026.

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Presiding Officer of the Senate

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14 Passed the House of Representatives the ____ day of _____,
15 2026.

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Presiding Officer of the House
of Representatives

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1 ENGROSSED HOUSE
2 BILL NO. 4427

By: Hilbert, Pogemiller,
Provenzano, Waldron, and
Ranson of the House

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8 An Act relating to adjunct teachers; amending Section
9 1, Chapter 210, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025,
10 Section 6-122.12), which relates to adjunct teachers;
11 authorizing public and charter school district to
12 hire adjunct teachers who are persons with
13 distinguished qualifications in their field;
14 directing the State Board of Education to promulgate
15 rules defining distinguished qualifications;
16 requiring adjunct teachers without a baccalaureate
17 degree to meet certain requirements; prohibiting
18 adjunct teachers from teaching core curriculum
19 subjects in pre-kindergarten through fourth grade
20 beginning with the 2026-2027 school year; permitting
21 previously employed adjunct teachers to continue to
22 teach core curriculum subjects in pre-kindergarten
23 through fourth grade if granted a waiver from the
24 State Board of Education; prohibiting an adjunct
teacher from teaching more than five years unless he
or she holds a teaching certificate, has completed
the requirements to become certified, or is on a
pathway to become certified within two years;
clarifying status of adjunct who does not hold a
valid certificate to teach; amending 70 O.S. 2021,
Section 6-122.3, as last amended by Section 162,
Chapter 452, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section
6-122.3), which relates to alternative placement
teaching certificate; removing adjunct teacher
language; providing an effective date; and declaring
an emergency.

1 BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

2 SECTION 4. AMENDATORY Section 1, Chapter 210, O.S.L.
3 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 6-122.12), is amended to read as
4 follows:

5 Section 6-122.12. A. Public and charter school districts in
6 Oklahoma shall be authorized to hire adjunct teachers who shall be
7 persons with distinguished qualifications in their field. The State
8 Board of Education shall promulgate rules defining distinguished
9 qualifications.

10 B. Adjunct teachers without a baccalaureate degree shall:

11 1. Be enrolled in a baccalaureate degree program with an
12 estimated completion of less than two (2) years and shall provide
13 proof of satisfactory completion of coursework to his or her
14 employing school district and the State Board of Education each
15 semester; or

16 2. Have a minimum of twenty (20) years of verifiable,
17 distinguished experience in the subject matter in which the person
18 will be employed as an adjunct teacher to instruct.

19 C. 1. Beginning with the 2026-2027 school year, adjunct
20 teachers shall not teach in core curriculum subjects, such as math,
21 English language arts, science, or social studies in pre-
22 kindergarten through fourth grade.

23 2. If a public or charter school district employed an adjunct
24 teacher to teach core curriculum classes in pre-kindergarten through

1 fourth grade prior to the 2026-2027 school year, the school district
2 may apply for a waiver to the State Board of Education. To be
3 eligible to apply for a waiver, the adjunct teacher shall have:

4 a. previously taught core curriculum classes in pre-
5 kindergarten through fourth grade, and

6 b. completed professional development training in the
7 science of reading.

8 If the waiver is granted by the State Board, the school district
9 may continue to employ the adjunct teacher to teach core curriculum
10 classes in pre-kindergarten through fourth grade.

11 D. An adjunct teacher shall not teach longer than five (5)
12 years unless he or she meets the following criteria:

13 1. Holds a valid teaching certificate;

14 2. Has completed the requirements to receive an alternate or
15 standard teaching certificate; or

16 3. Is on a pathway to complete alternative or standard
17 certification within the next two (2) years. If certification is
18 not achieved within two (2) years, the adjunct teacher shall no
19 longer be employed as an adjunct teacher.

20 E. A person employed as an adjunct teacher pursuant to this
21 section who does not hold a valid certificate to teach shall not be
22 considered a teacher as defined by Section 1-116 of this title.

23 F. The State Department of Education shall publish an annual
24 report on the status of adjunct teachers, authorized by Section 6-

1 122.3 of ~~Title 70 of the Oklahoma Statutes~~ this title, in this
2 state. The report shall include:

3 1. Qualifications adopted by the State Board of Education to
4 determine eligibility of adjunct teacher candidates;

5 2. The subject areas or courses in which adjunct teachers are
6 teaching; and

7 3. The types of distinguished qualifications adjunct teachers
8 have to make them qualified to teach in certain subject areas or
9 courses.

10 ~~B.~~ G. The annual report shall be published on the website of
11 the State Department of Education and copies of the report shall be
12 provided to ~~elected~~ members of the Oklahoma House of Representatives
13 and the Oklahoma State Senate no later than January 15 of each year.

14 SECTION 5. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 6-122.3, as
15 last amended by Section 162, Chapter 452, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp.
16 2025, Section 6-122.3), is amended to read as follows:

17 Section 6-122.3. A. The State Board of Education shall grant
18 an alternative placement teaching certificate to a person who makes
19 application to the Board and meets the following criteria:

20 1. a. holds at least a baccalaureate degree from an
21 institution whose accreditation is recognized by the
22 Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education and has
23 attained a retention grade point average of not less
24 than 2.50 on a 4.0 scale, or

1 b. has successfully completed a terminal degree, such as
2 a doctorate of philosophy, a doctorate in education,
3 professional doctorates, a master of fine arts degree
4 or a master of library science degree, from an
5 institution accredited by a national or regional
6 accrediting agency which is recognized by the
7 Secretary of the United States Department of
8 Education. The Oklahoma State Regents for Higher
9 Education shall be consulted to verify other terminal
10 degrees, or

11 c. holds at least a baccalaureate degree from an
12 institution whose accreditation is recognized by the
13 Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education and has
14 qualified work experience in a field that corresponds
15 to an area of certification as determined by the State
16 Board of Education, and

17 d. in addition to the requirements of subparagraphs a, b
18 and c of this paragraph, has demonstrated competency
19 or completed a major in a field that corresponds to an
20 area of specialization for an Elementary-Secondary
21 Certificate or a Secondary Certificate as determined
22 by the State Board of Education or a vocational-
23 technical certificate as recommended by the Oklahoma
24 Department of Career and Technology Education;

1 2. Declares the intention to earn standard certification by
2 means of an alternative placement program in not more than three (3)
3 years. The State Board of Education shall determine the subject
4 matter and the number of clock or semester hours required for the
5 professional education component for each person making application
6 for an alternative placement teaching certificate based on the
7 criteria of paragraph 1 of this subsection.

8 The State Board of Education shall establish a core minimum of
9 six (6) semester hours or ninety (90) clock hours and a maximum of
10 eighteen (18) semester hours or two hundred seventy (270) clock
11 hours for the professional education component.

12 The requirements set forth in this subsection shall exclude all
13 student teaching requirements pursuant to the provisions of
14 subsection E of this section;

15 3. Has passed the subject area portion of the competency
16 examination required in Section 6-187 of this title in the area of
17 specialization for which certification is sought; and

18 4. Either presents a document from an accredited public school
19 district in this state offering employment in the area of
20 specialization for which certification is sought on condition that
21 the person enroll in an alternative placement program approved by
22 the State Board of Education or declares the intention to seek
23 employment as a teacher at an accredited public school district in
24 this state. The certificate granted pursuant to this subsection

1 shall be considered a "valid certificate of qualification" for the
2 purposes of Sections 6-107 and 6-108 of this title, and the holder
3 of the certificate shall be considered an inductee for the purposes
4 of Section 6-195 of this title.

5 B. An alternative placement teaching certificate shall be
6 renewed for not more than a maximum of three (3) years upon
7 presentation of a document from an accredited public school district
8 in this state offering renewed employment in the same area of
9 specialization and a document from a teacher education institution
10 verifying satisfactory progress in an appropriate alternative
11 placement program.

12 C. Persons enrolled in an alternative placement program shall:

13 1. Have never been denied admittance to a teacher education
14 program approved by the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education,
15 the North Central Association of Colleges and Schools and by the
16 Oklahoma Commission for Teacher Preparation to offer teacher
17 education programs, nor have enrolled in and subsequently failed
18 courses necessary to successfully meet the minimum requirements of
19 the program, except those persons who hold a certificate;

20 2. Have on file with the director of teacher education at an
21 Oklahoma institution of higher education a plan for meeting standard
22 certification requirements within three (3) years; and
23
24

1 3. Participate in an induction program as required in Section
2 6-195 of this title and have the same duties and responsibilities as
3 other inductees.

4 D. The State Board of Education may grant an exception to the
5 requirements for certification and, upon demonstration by an
6 individual of specific competency in the subject area of
7 specialization, may grant a certificate to the individual. The
8 State Board may establish other requirements necessary to grant
9 exceptions.

10 E. The State Board of Education, in consultation with the
11 Commission for Educational Quality and Accountability, may grant an
12 exception to the requirement to complete a subject area examination
13 for initial certification in a field which does not require an
14 advanced degree pursuant to this section if the candidate has an
15 advanced degree in a subject that is substantially comparable to the
16 content assessed on a subject area examination. The degree shall be
17 from an institution accredited by a national or regional accrediting
18 agency which is recognized by the Secretary of the U.S. Department
19 of Education. The Commission shall provide the Board with the
20 necessary information to determine comparability.

21 F. Student teaching and a ~~pre-student~~ pre-student teaching field
22 experience shall not be required of alternative placement program
23 participants for standard certification.

1 ~~G. The State Board of Education shall promulgate rules~~
2 ~~authorizing adjunct teachers who shall be persons with distinguished~~
3 ~~qualifications in their field. Adjunct teachers shall not be~~
4 ~~required to meet standard certification. A person employed as an~~
5 ~~adjunct teacher pursuant to this subsection who does not hold a~~
6 ~~valid certificate to teach shall not be considered a teacher as~~
7 ~~defined by Section 1-116 of this title.~~

8 ~~H.~~ Each teacher education institution shall provide the
9 Oklahoma Commission for Teacher Preparation an annual report of
10 information as specified by the Commission regarding participation
11 in the alternative placement programs offered by the institution.

12 ~~F.~~ H. The Oklahoma Commission for Teacher Preparation shall not
13 accredit, renew the accreditation of, or otherwise approve any
14 teacher education program of any institution of higher education in
15 this state that has not implemented alternative placement programs
16 in at least four areas of specialization, including mathematics,
17 science, and a foreign language. Each institution shall allow
18 individuals who meet the criteria of subsections A and C of this
19 section to be:

20 1. Admitted to an alternative placement program without further
21 qualification; and

22 2. Offered the opportunity to complete the requirements for
23 standard certification set forth in subsection A of this section
24 during the summer preceding and the summer following the first year

1 of teaching with an alternative placement teaching certificate. Any
2 person seeking standard certification through an alternative
3 placement program shall be permitted to take necessary courses
4 during regular semesters if offered.

5 ~~J.~~ I. The criteria specified in subsection ~~F~~ H of this section
6 can be met through a cooperative arrangement entered into by two or
7 more institutions of higher education.

8 SECTION 6. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

9 SECTION 7. It being immediately necessary for the preservation
10 of the public peace, health or safety, an emergency is hereby
11 declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and
12 be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

13 Passed the House of Representatives the 23rd day of March, 2026.

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15 _____
16 Presiding Officer of the House
of Representatives

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18 Passed the Senate the _____ day of _____, 2026.

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20 _____
21 Presiding Officer of the Senate
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